

Board 1

West Deals

None Vul

♠ Q J 9 8
♥ Q 10 3
♦ A 9 4 2
♣ 10 7

♠ K 5 2

♥ A 9 6

♦ K Q 5

♣ K Q J 2



♠ 10 4

♥ K J 7 5 2

♦ 10 8 3

♣ 8 5 3

♠ A 7 6 3

♥ 8 4

♦ J 7 6

♣ A 9 6 4

West	North	East	South
Pass	1♣	Pass	1♠
Pass	2NT	Pass	3NT
All Pass			

3NT by North
♥Q.

This sure looks like an opening 1NT hand, except for one little thing - it is too strong. Make sure you open 1NT **ONLY** with hands containing 15-17 points. For this one you open 1♣. Partner responds 1♠.

Do not support partner's Major suit response with only 3 cards. It is good to raise partner's Major suit **OPENING** with 3 trumps because he guarantees a 5-card suit. As a **RESPONSE** he only promises a 4-card suit, so you should have 4 in the suit to give immediate support.

In fact you have a perfect bid. With a balanced hand and 18-19 points you open 1 of a suit, then jump in Notrump. Holding 18 points you bid 2NT and partner raises to 3NT.

North plays 3NT. East leads the ♥5. West plays the

North plays 3NT. East leads the ♥5. West plays the ♥Q.

Winner count: ♠ 2 : ♥ 1 : ♦ 0 : ♣ 4 : Total = 7

You need 2 more winners and they will come from the ♦ suit once you have forced out the ♦ A. There is a problem though. When the opponents get the lead with the ♦ A they might cash 4 ♥ tricks. Of course if it is West who wins the ♦ A and if he doesn't have a ♥ to play then all will be well. So you don't take your ♥ A on the first trick, nor do you take it on the second trick. At trick 3 you have no choice so you win your ♥ A.

Now you can take your 4 ♣ tricks if you like. Then lead a ♦ honor. If they don't take their ♦ A on this trick you play another ♦ honor. One of the defenders will win this trick. If it is West you will make your contract, if it is East you will go down.

Visualize what would happen if you played the ♥ A on the first or second trick. When you tried to establish ♦ tricks West would take the ♦ A and play a ♥ to East and you would go down 1. By waiting until the third round to take the ♥ A you exhaust West of his ♥s.

Notice that if East was the one who had the ♦ A then you would go down despite your hold-up play. This PLAN is not a guarantee - but if you follow it you will make the contract 50% of the time. If you don't follow it you will make the contract 0% of the time.

Board 3

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A Q J 2
 ♥ 10 7 4 2
 ♦ 10 9
 ♣ A Q 4

♠ K 8 6 5

♥ 9

♦ K Q J 4

♣ K J 10 7



♠ 3

♥ A K Q J 8 3

♦ 8 6 3

♣ 9 6 3

♠ 10 9 7 4

♥ 6 5

♦ A 7 5 2

♣ 8 5 2

West

North

East

South

1♦

1♥

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by East

chance. You and partner hold 23 HCP. South has already produced 4 HCP with the ♦A, and if he had 3 more that would mean North opened with only 10 points. Very doubtful.

So face it, North has the ♣K.

However, dummy has some nice ♠ cards. So you pull the last trump, play your ♠3 to dummy's ♠A, then lead the ♠Q. If North puts on his ♠K (which you know he must have) you ruff it. Then enter dummy with a ♦ ruff and discard the small ♣ on the good ♠J. If North doesn't play his ♠K you discard your ♣ loser immediately.

If you separate the bidding from the play in your mind you will too often miss clues that should be telling you that certain plans will or won't work.

This was a perfect example. After the opening lead it was easy to deduce that all the rest of the high cards had to be in the North hand.

With 12 points and an excellent suit you overcall 1♥.

Partner raises to 4♥ and everyone passes.

East plays 4♥. South leads the ♦A and the defense wins two high ♦s then switches to a trump.

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Losers: ♠ 0 : ♥ 0 : ♦ 2 : ♣ 2 : Total = 4

The two ♦ losers are already lost, so you must eliminate a ♣ loser. If South has the ♣K then a simple finesse will win the day. That would be a 50% chance, right? **WRONG!** That would be a 0%